

XFX 7600GT Fatal1ty Edition

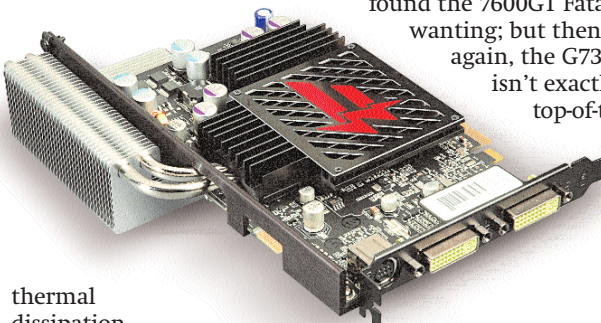
A non-fatal force!

So Jonathan "Fatal1ty" Wendell gets his nickname endorsed by yet another gaming brand. XFX joins Creative, Abit, and Zalman in this respect.

The XFX 7600GT Fatal1ty Edition is seriously more than just another G73 wannabe. It sports a completely fanless design, opting instead for a silent albeit bulkier heatpipe-heatsink design. The memory is cooled by discrete metal strips that have nothing to do with the heatpipe solution which evidently only cools the GPU.

As expected, the solution is decidedly bulky, cooling a core like the G73 (basically a stripped down version of NVIDIA's formidable 7900GTX a.k.a. the G70 chipset). Part of the radiator-looking cooling fins extend

to the reverse of the card; ditto the heatpipes. What's good is the heatpipes are not glued to the heatsink. Rather, they're soldered, which aids



thermal dissipation.

We tested the 7600GT with a more than modest Core 2 Duo X6800 with 2 GB of DDR2 800 MHz memory. The XFX 7600GT brings up 7041 3D2005 Marks, about on par with other cards based on the

same core. F.E.A.R. brings up 85 fps at maximum settings with a resolution of 1024 x 768. This makes the 7600GT a very decent solution for current-generation games at toned-down settings.

Once the resolution and settings were cranked up, we found the 7600GT Fatal1ty wanting; but then again, the G73 isn't exactly top-of-the-

line; nor was it intended to be even in its heyday.

At Rs 11,500, XFX's Fatal1ty Edition will provide any PC with some perky multimedia performance while not adding to system noise. Gamers will look elsewhere, as the G73 is an outdated core. For all other NVIDIA, fans the DirectX 10 replacements to the 7600GT (GeForce 8600 and 8300) are already close to seeing Indian shores. Irrespective of your needs, we suggest holding your horses, umm, wallets a bit longer and look at the way things play out.

Specifications

core: G73 core @ 560 MHz; memory: 256 MB GDDR3 @ 1400 MHz; dual DVI outs

Contact: : Rashi Peripherals Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-67090909
E-mail: divya@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.xfxforce.com
Price: Rs. 11,500

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Creative Zen V Plus

Audio: hot; Video: not

Flash-based, small and feature-rich—that's the Zen V Plus. The trendy colour combination adds to its appeal. The 1 GB Zen V Plus is available in black or white with orange highlights; the 2 GB model has green highlights, and the 4 GB version comes with blue accents—ditto the 8 GB version.

The device is well-built and feels very sturdy. The controls are easily accessible and the buttons well-placed; opinions differed about the joystick. FM radio and video playback round off the features list. The Zen V Plus interfaces with you via a bright, 1.5-inch, 128 x 128 OLED screen.

A good software bundle comes along, and the device

syncs with WMP 10 and above to transfer music and videos.



It supports MP3, WAV, and WMA audio formats. Then there's the excellent line-in recording feature that allows you to record to MP3 at 128 or 160 kbps.

Videos such as those in the DivX and AVI formats

are transcoded to the Zen's proprietary format; however, the resolution at 128 x 96 @ 12 fps doesn't really cut it. Audio quality is the Zen V Plus' forte. It delivers rich highs and decent vocals. Bass is good, but not deep enough to be classified as excellent. On the default headphones, the Zen V Plus sounds similar to the iPod nano. Actually, the right set of phones will allow you to experience the full output range the device is capable of—we attest to this!

With the feature set and user-

friendliness on offer, the Zen V Plus is one attractive package. We don't think the lack of good video playback should matter; think of it as an added feature. Creative has other products in their portfolio that handle video very well indeed. If you want a great-sounding, feature-rich MP3 player that's on par with the iPod nano but much smaller, the Creative Zen V Plus is the way to go.

Specifications

Dimensions (WxLxD): 43.5 x 67.5 x 15.9 mm; 43.5 g; screen: 1.5 inches (128x128 pixels); 1/2/4/8 GB; MP3/WMA/WAV; Line-in MP3 recording; JPEG support; transcodes video; embedded Li-Ion battery

Contact: Creative Technology Ltd
Phone: 9821455590
E-mail: irfan@ctl.creative.com
Web site: www.creative.com
Price: Rs. 7,499 (1 GB)

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★